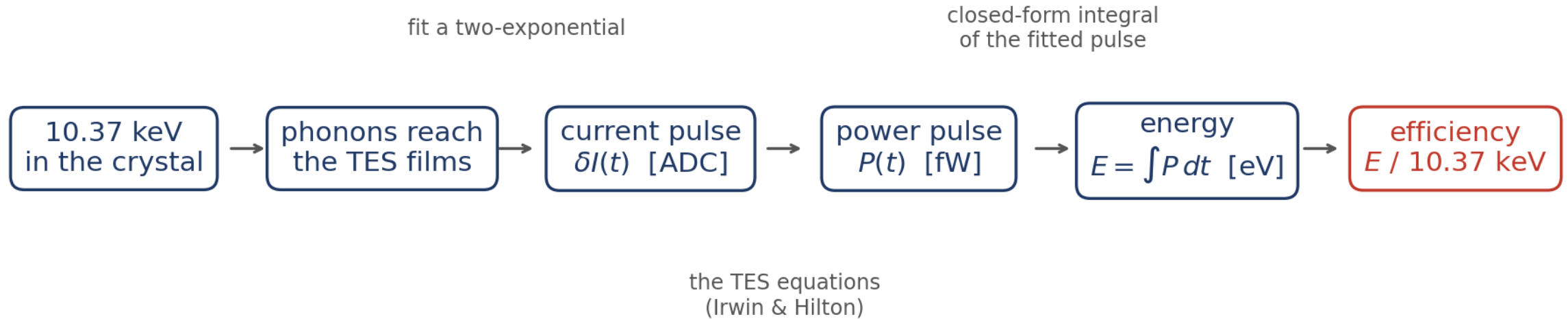


Phonon collection efficiency of Z7

Zhiheng Li · University of Minnesota · SuperCDMS SNOLAB Run 4 · September 2026
github.com/ZhihengLi0/urop → [snolab/collection_efficiency/](#)

The question



Collection efficiency = energy that reaches the TES films ÷ the 10.37 keV of the event

What we record is a current pulse.

The area under a current is not an energy — so the pulse must be turned into power first.

Sample: Z7, the K-line events of the Ge activation run (2207 events, 30 series, all 11 channels saved raw).

From current to power, from power to energy

$$P(t) = I_0 (R_L - R_0) \delta I(t) + 2 R_L (\delta I(t))^2$$

linear term

quadratic term

$$E = \int P(t) dt = I_0 (R_L - R_0) A (\tau_f - \tau_r) + 2 R_L A^2 \left(\frac{\tau_f + \tau_r}{2} - \frac{2 \tau_f \tau_r}{\tau_f + \tau_r} \right)$$

for the fitted pulse $\delta I(t) = A [e^{-t/\tau_f} - e^{-t/\tau_r}]$ integrated from $-\infty$ to $+\infty$: zero before it starts, decays to zero after

Z7 PBS1 bias point (measured, from detectorConfig): $I_0 = -18.07 \mu\text{A}$, $R_0 = 44.16 \text{ m}\Omega$, $R_L = R_p + R_{sh} = 19.24 \text{ m}\Omega$

$$\Rightarrow I_0 (R_L - R_0) = 4.50 \times 10^{-7} \text{ V} \quad \text{and} \quad 2 R_L = 0.0385 \Omega$$

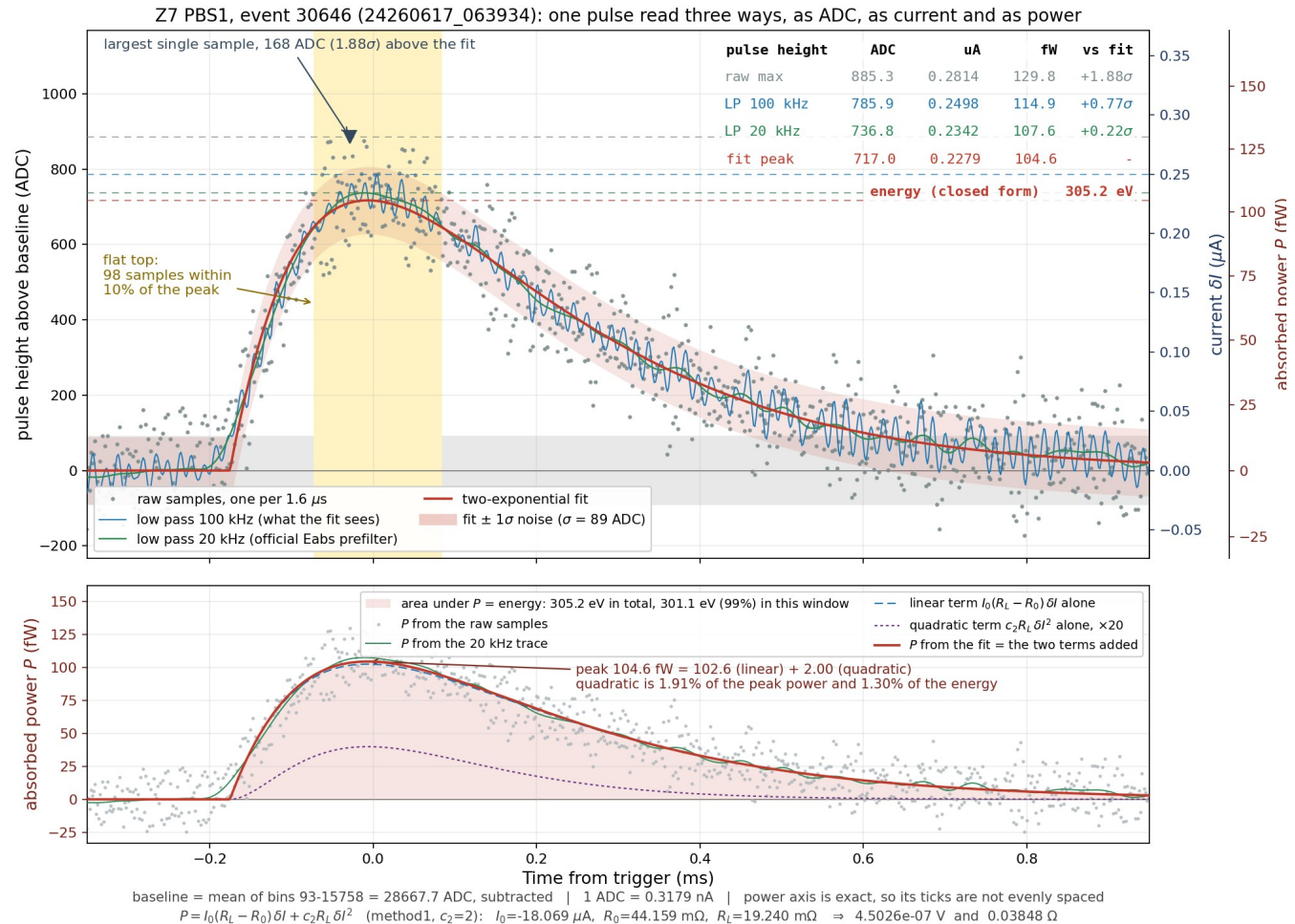
Power = the change of Joule heating when the current moves by δI : a linear term and a small quadratic term.

Both coefficients are the measured bias point of the channel — nothing is fitted or tuned.

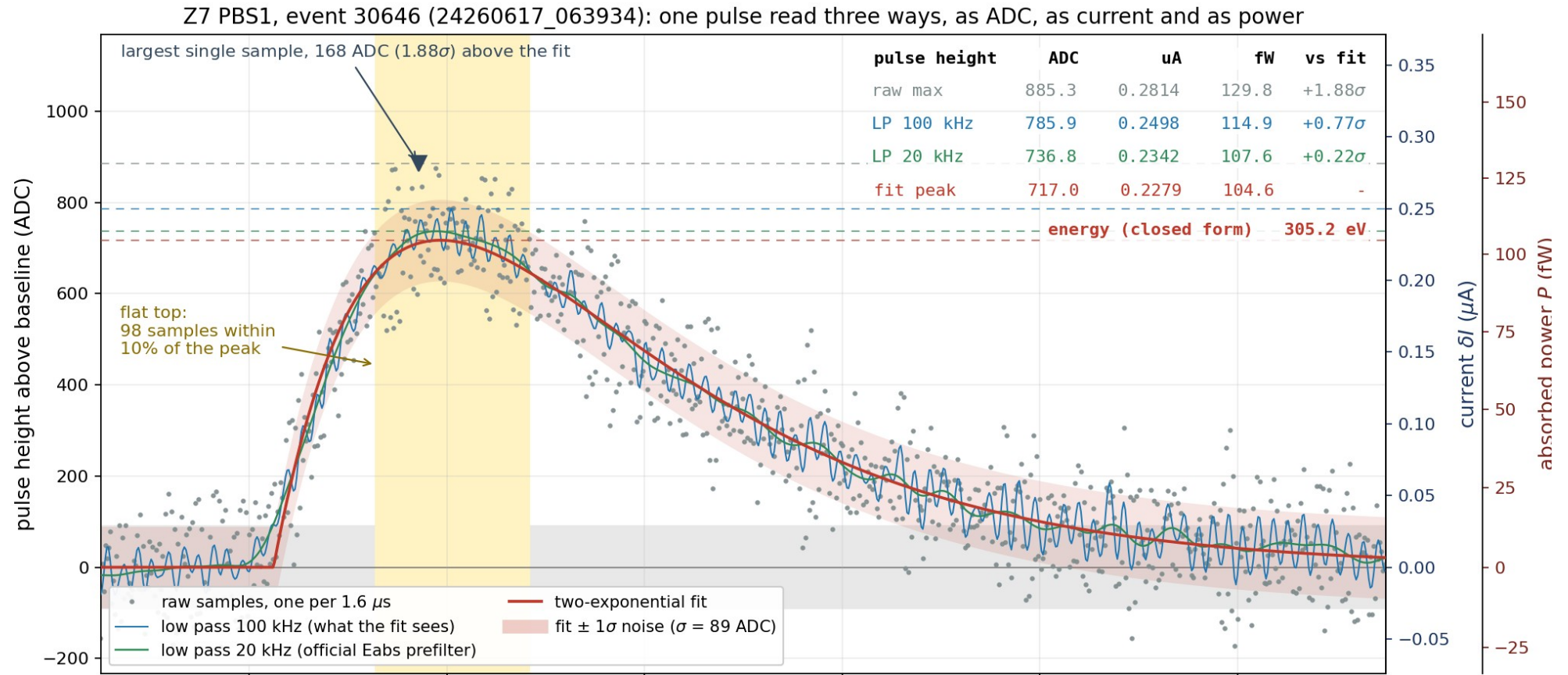
Fit the two-exponential, integrate it from $-\infty$ to $+\infty$: the energy is a formula in A , τ_f , τ_r .

One pulse, read three ways

Z7 PBS1, event 30646: the same trace as ADC counts, as current, as power



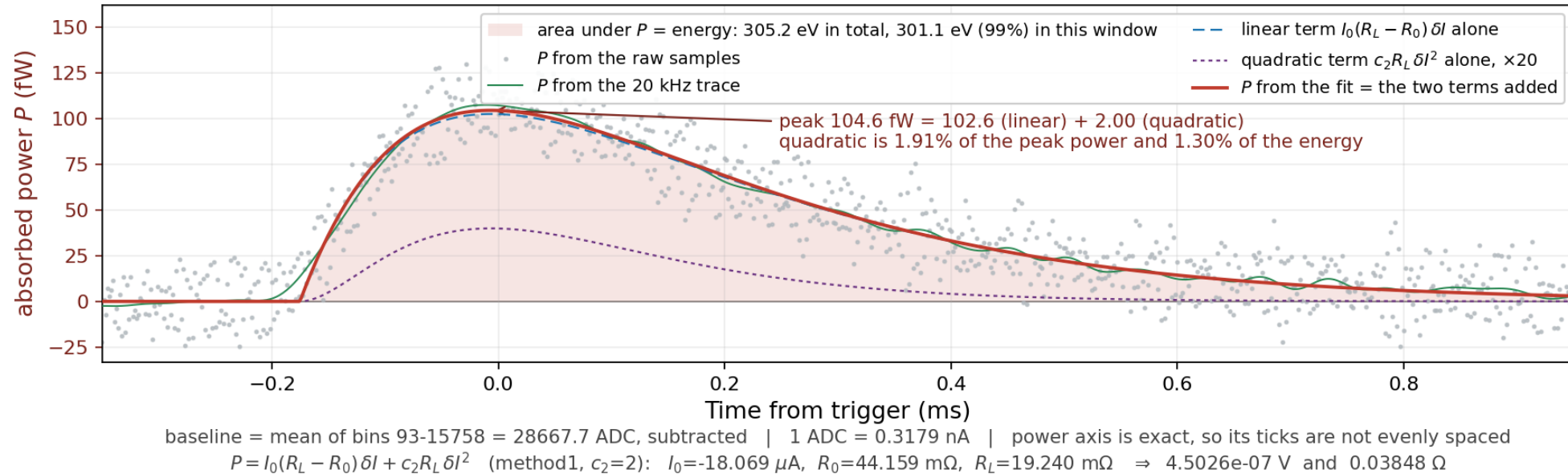
The height: take it from the fit, not from the largest sample



Yellow band: 98 samples sit within 10 % of the peak. The largest of them is the largest noise excursion.

Largest raw sample 885 ADC, fit 717 ADC: the maximum reads 23 % high. Filtering helps; the fit removes it.

The power pulse, and its area is the energy



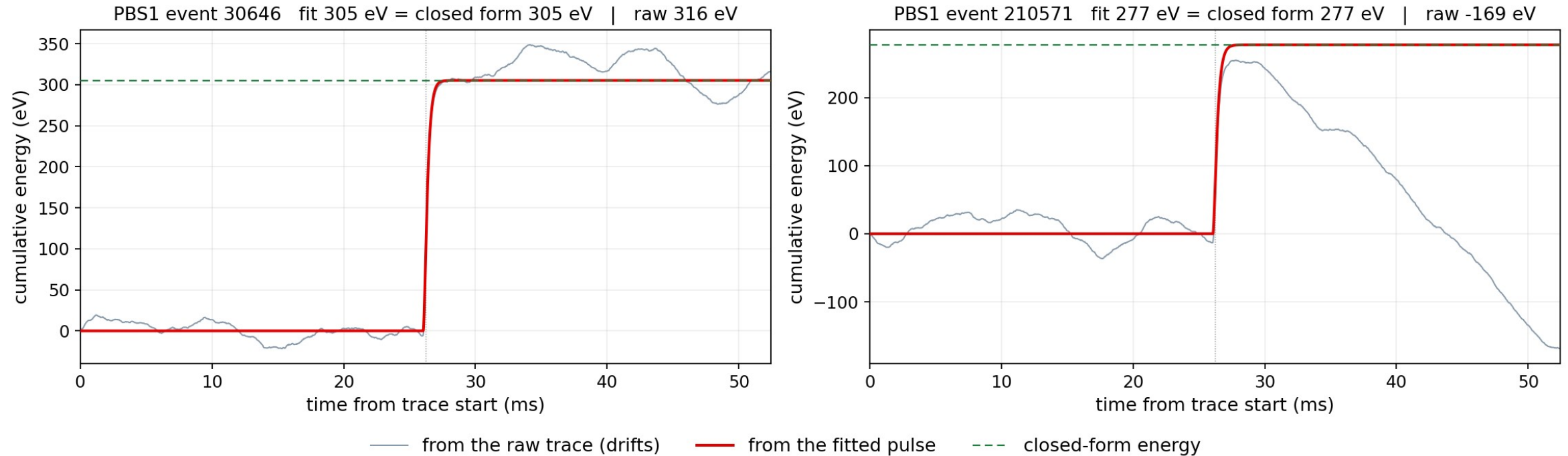
Red: the fitted current put through the formula. Blue dashed: the linear term alone. Purple: the quadratic term, $\times 20$.

The quadratic term is 1.9 % of the peak — the power pulse has the shape of the current pulse.

The shaded area is the energy this channel absorbed: 305 eV.

Why the fitted pulse is integrated, and not the data

energy accumulated from the start of the 52 ms trace; trigger at the dotted line

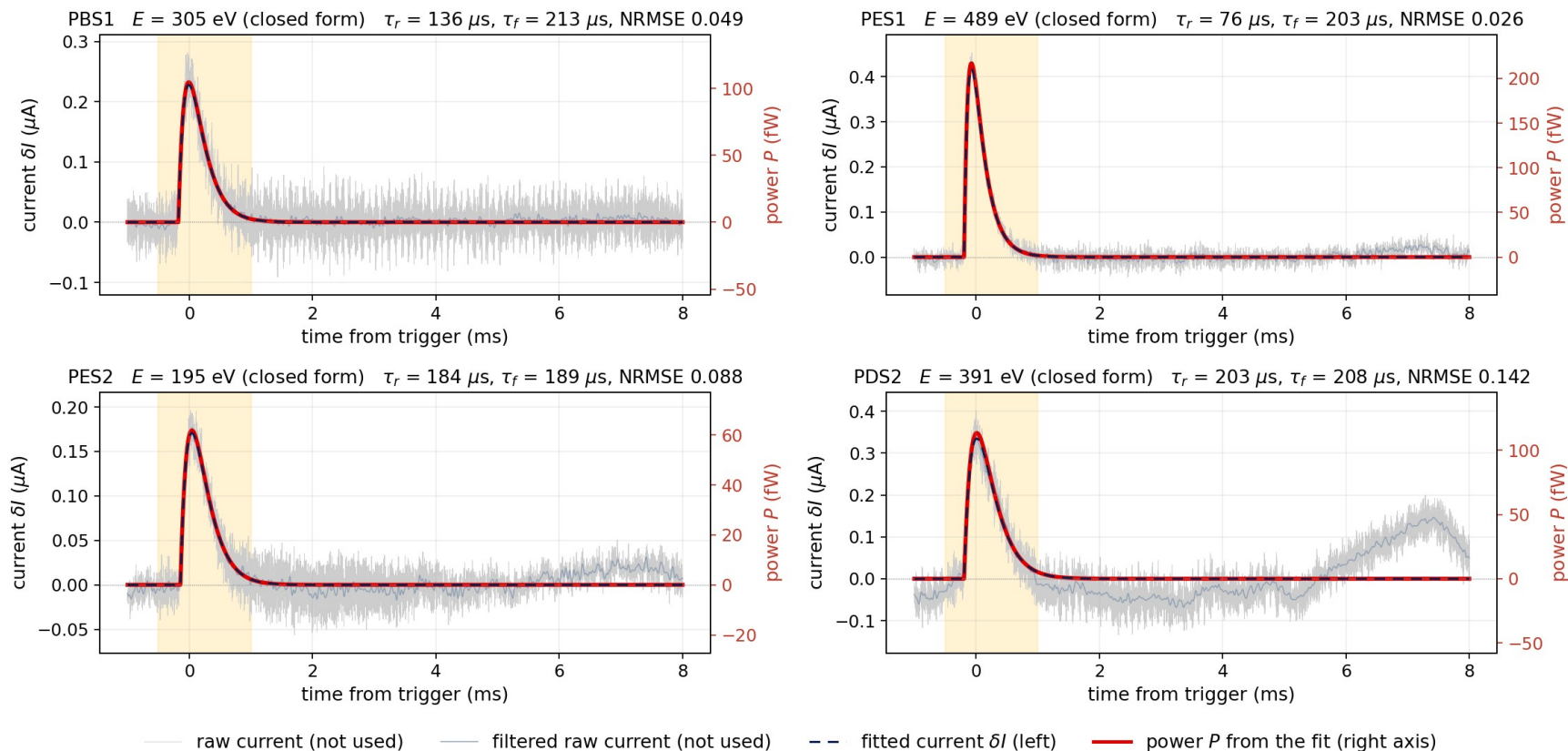


Red, from the fit: nothing before the pulse, up within 1 ms, then flat — and the end value is exactly the formula.

Grey, from the raw trace: it drifts. A 1 nA baseline offset over 15 ms is already 42 eV. Right: fit 277 eV, raw -169 eV.

The same event in its other channels: they add up to 33 %

Z7 event 30646; four of the eleven channels

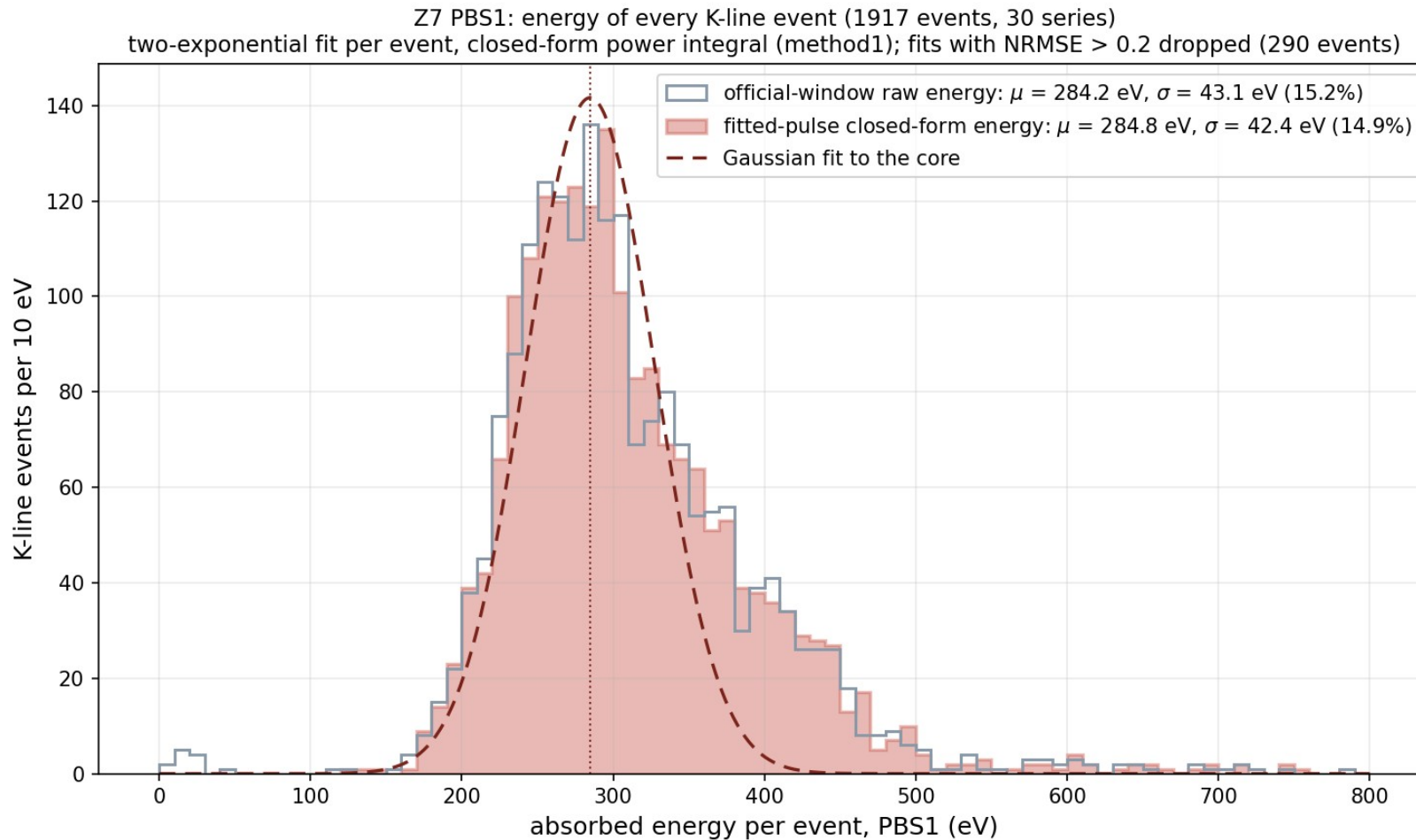


The channels share the energy unevenly (PES1 489 eV, PES2 195 eV): the event sat closer to one side.

Summed over the eleven channels: 3419 eV = 33.0 % of 10.37 keV. PDS2 (bottom right) carries a slow swing — remember it.

Now every event: one channel gives a wide, lopsided distribution

PBS1, 1917 K-line events, one fit and one integral each



Red: from the fit. Grey: the official window on the raw trace. Same peak to 0.2 %.

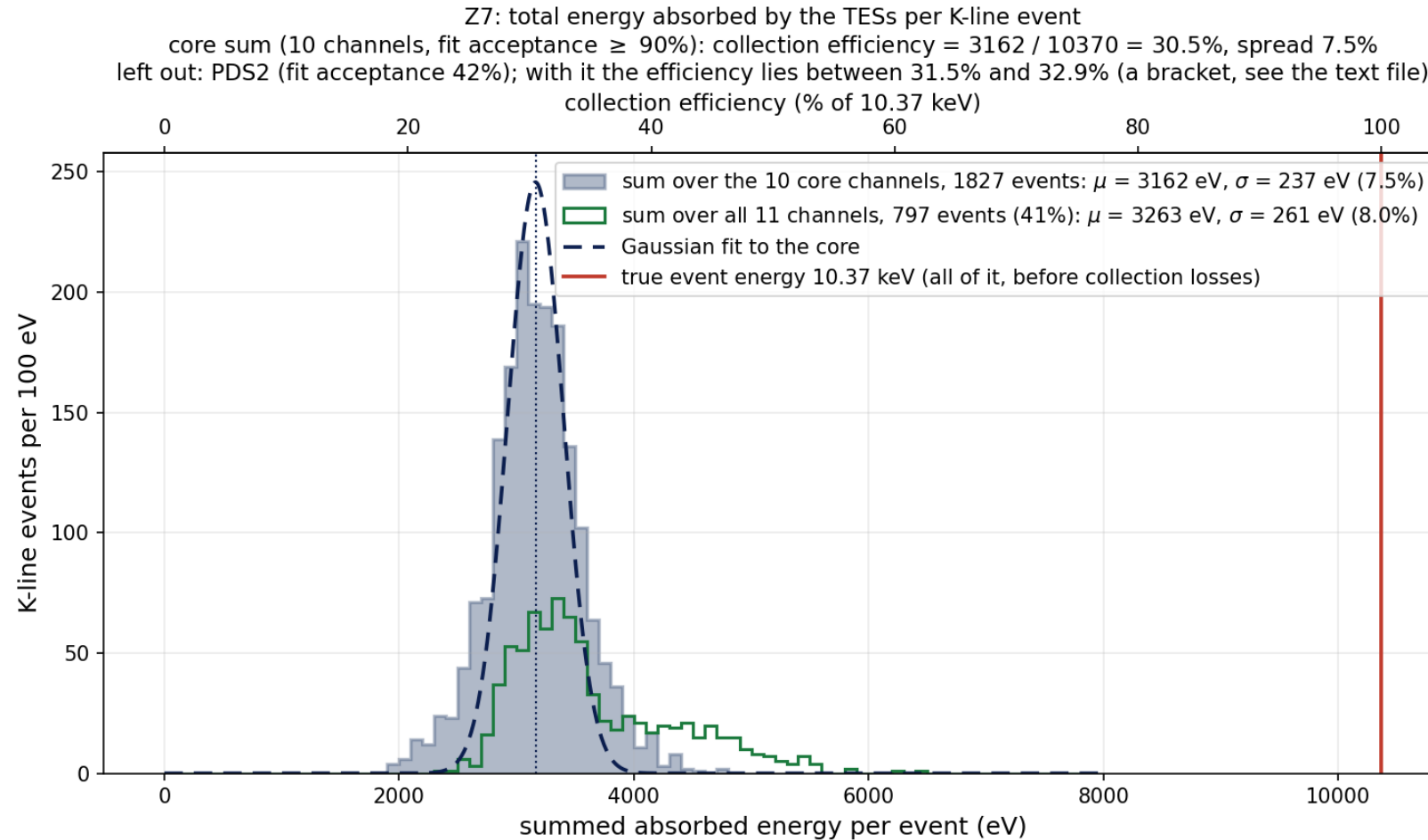
Peak 285 eV, width 15 % — for a line whose energy is fixed.

The tail to the right is the events that happened near this channel.

One channel's width is event position, not noise.

Summed over the channels: $32 \pm 1 \%$

the total energy the TESs absorbed per K-line event



Ten channels summed, 1827 events: 3162 eV = 30.5 %, and the width drops to 7.5 % — the position effect cancels.

PDS2 fits only 42 % of the events (that slow swing), and those events are not typical; its share can only be bracketed.

Full efficiency 31.5–32.9 %: $32 \pm 1 \%$.

Red line: 10.37 keV — two thirds of the energy never reaches the TESs.

Summary, and what is still open

A current pulse becomes a power pulse through the TES equations; the area under the power is the energy. The quadratic term is 2 %.

The energy comes from the fitted pulse, integrated from $-\infty$ to $+\infty$: no bias from the noisy maximum, no drift.

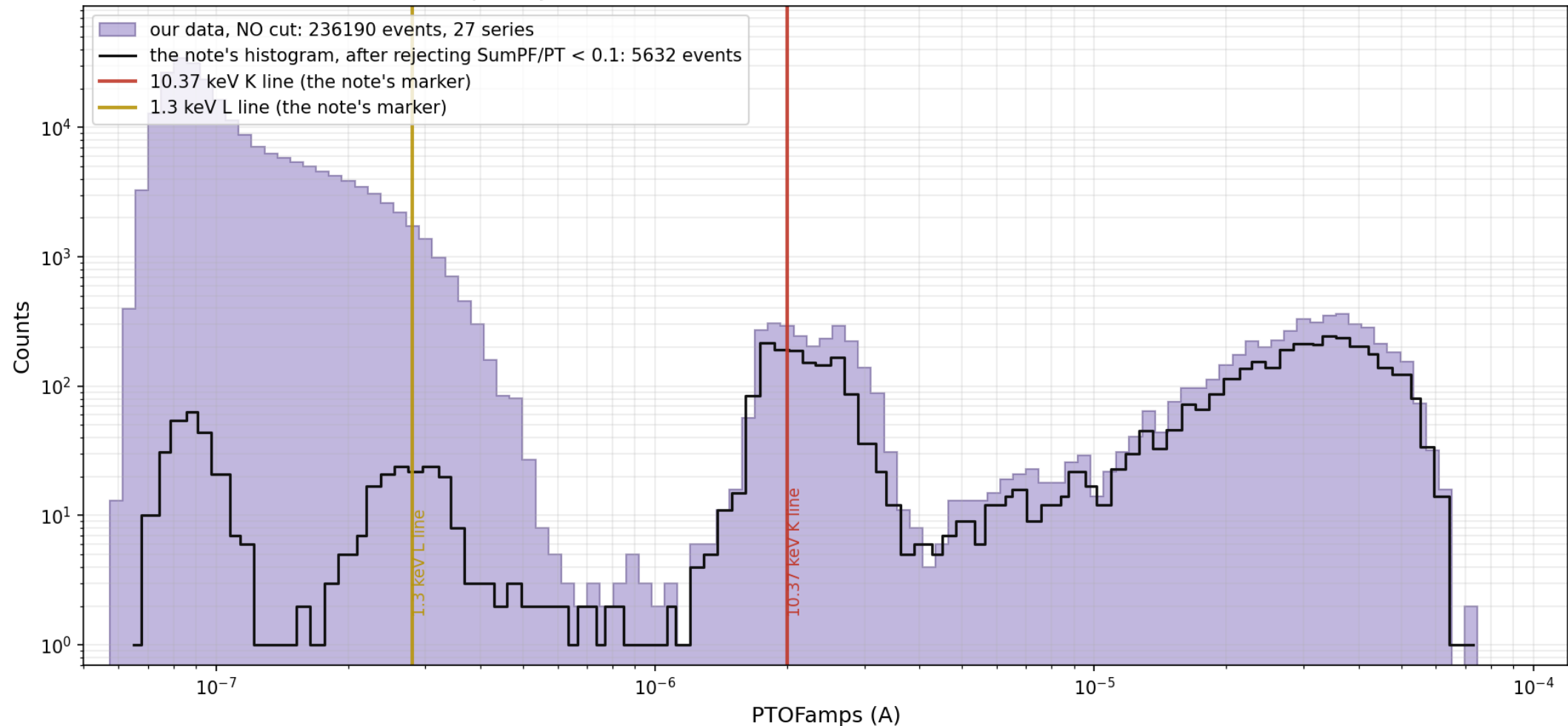
One channel: 15 % wide and lopsided (position). Ten channels summed: 7.5 % and symmetric.

Z7 absorbs 32 ± 1 % of a 10.37 keV event in its TESs. The CDMS note on the R37 CUTE tower reports 26–41 %.

Open: Z7 only · the HV bias of Z7 is not established (0 V assumed) · no dI/dV , so the inductor term is dropped · PDS2 is the ± 1 % · 12.5 % of events fit in no channel and are not in the histograms.

Backup — the events

Z7: summed PTOFamps over 27 series, rebuilt from the Prompt processing with no cut applied
the note's version of the same plot rejects SumPF/PT below 0.1; the difference between the two curves is what that cut removes



Backup — the three versions of the power formula

$P = I_0(R_L - R_0) \cdot \delta I + c_2 \cdot R_L \cdot (\delta I)^2$ with $c_2 = 2$ (Method 1, used here), 1 (exact small-signal), -1 (Method 2)

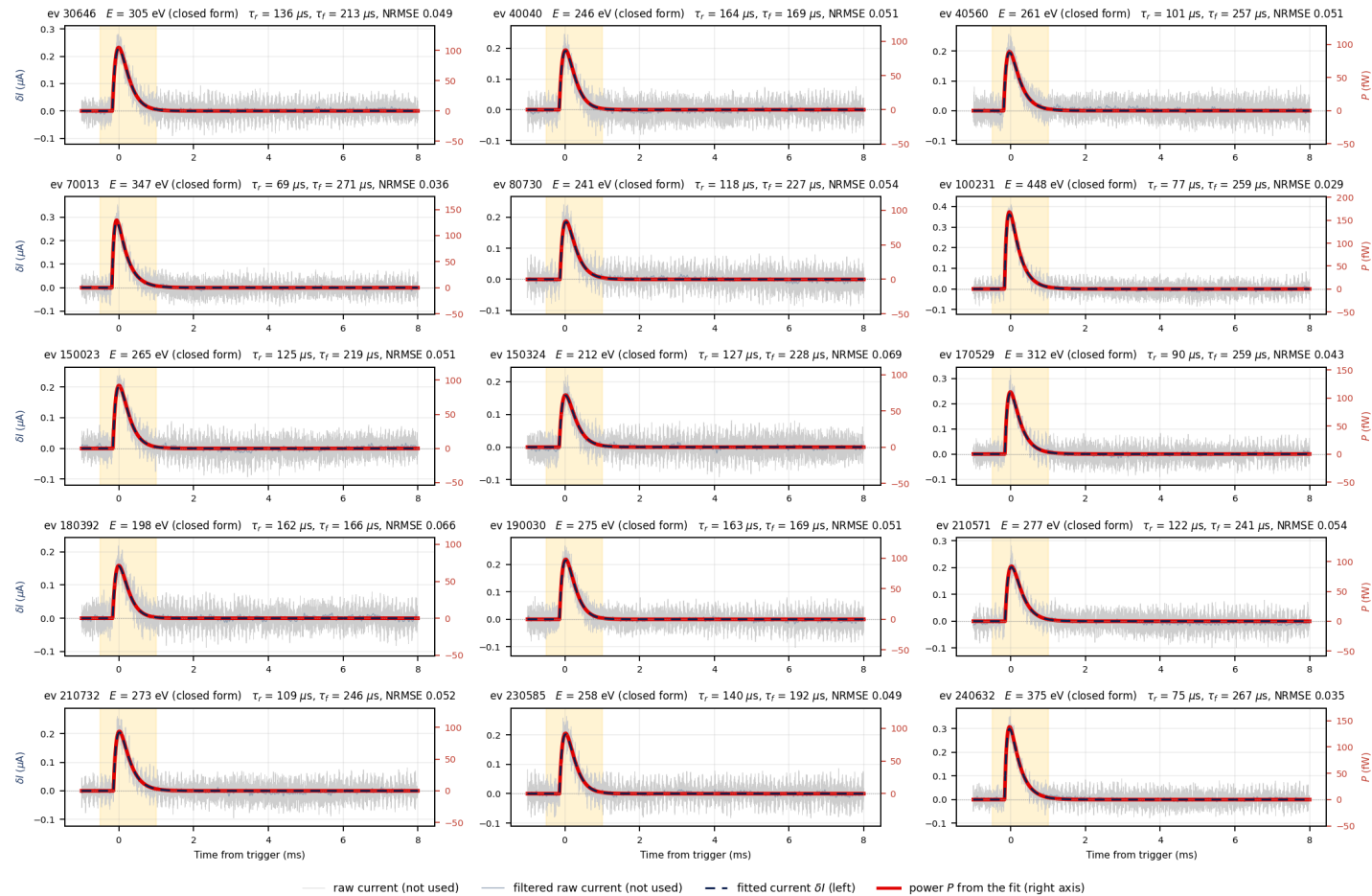
Relative to the exact form: Method 1 +0.58 %, Method 2 -1.15 % in energy — far below the 15 % single-channel width and the PDS2 bracket.

The inductor term of the full equations needs L and the loop gain from dI/dV , which do not exist for these series on MSI; it is neglected.

The official Eabs (trigger bin 16383, baseline bins 93..15758, 5-pole 20 kHz prefilter, window -0.5/+1 ms, same formula) is reproduced to 0.2 %; the grey outlines on the histogram slides are it.

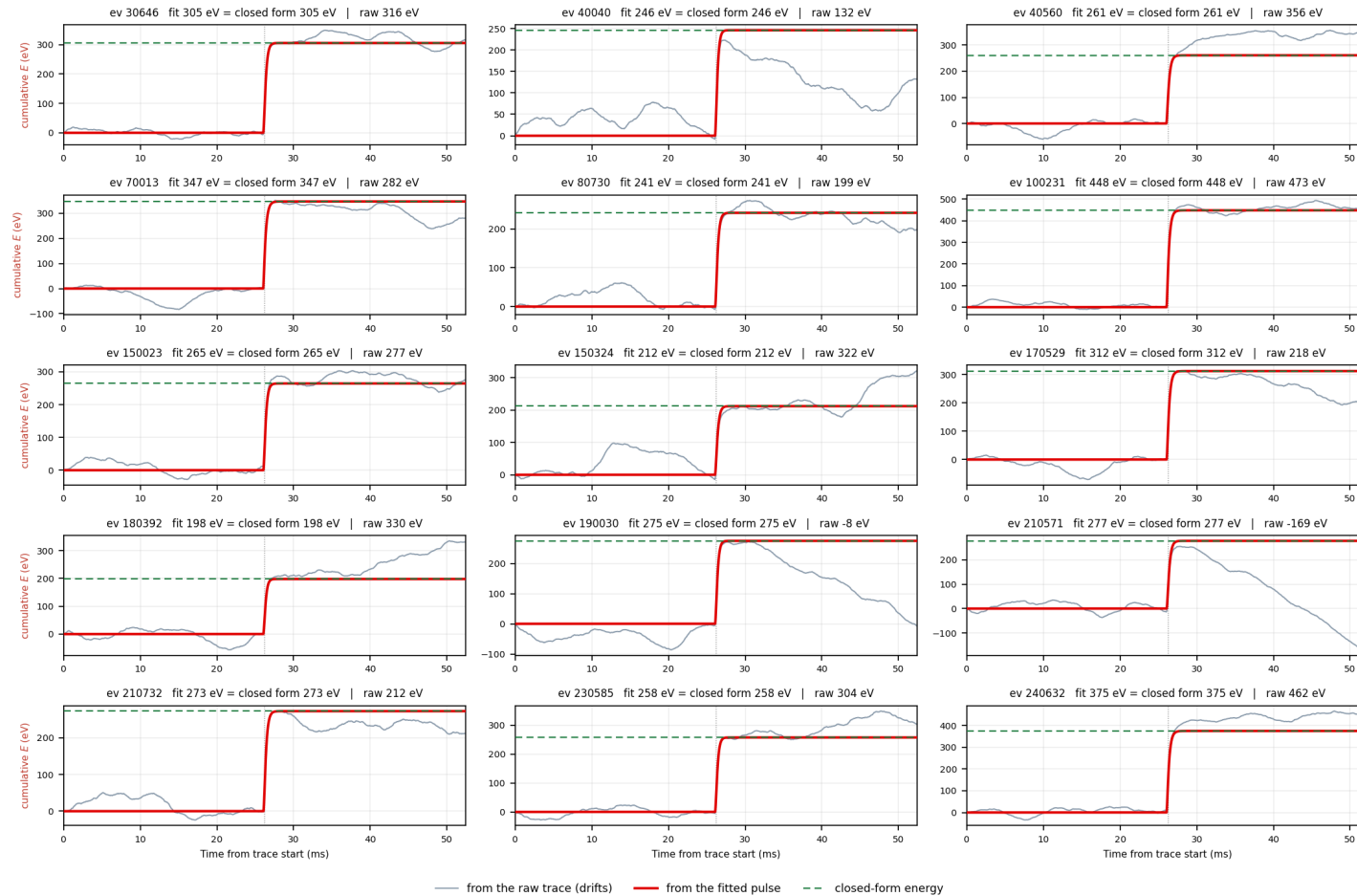
Backup — 15 events, fitted current and power (PBS1)

Z7 PBS1: fitted current pulse (dashed navy) and the power pulse it implies (red)
 Z7 24260617_063934, K-line events | method1: $P(t) = I_0(R_L R_0) \cdot dI(t) + 2 \cdot R_L \cdot L \cdot (dI(t))^2$ | bias point per channel from detectorConfig, ADC/A = 3.145728e+09
 the current is the two-exponential FIT, refitted directly in amperes (model $A[\exp(-t/\tau_r) - \exp(-t/\tau_f)]$), 5 free params, pretrigger free in 16383+-3000; the raw trace is drawn only for reference
 integration runs over the whole trace, 0 to 52.43 ms; for the fitted pulse this equals the closed-form integral, so the energy no longer depends on the window



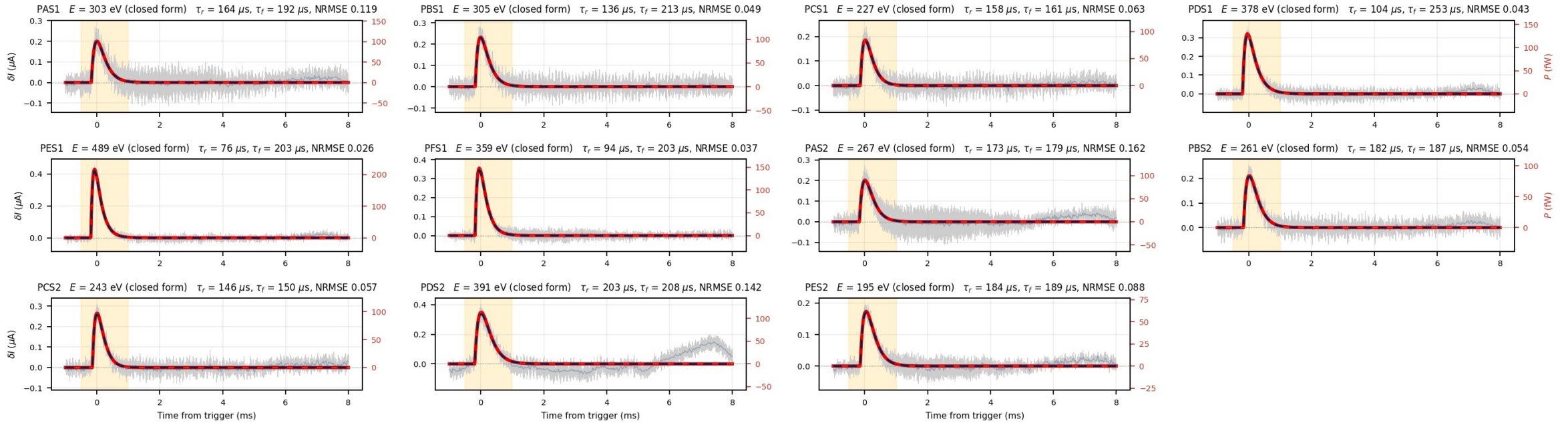
Backup — 15 events, cumulative energy (PBS1)

Z7 PBS1: integrated power = absorbed energy, fitted pulse vs raw trace
 Z7 24260617_063934, K-line events | method1: $P(t) = 10(R_L R_0) \cdot d(t) + 2 \cdot R_L \cdot L \cdot (d(t))^2$ | bias point per channel from detectorConfig, ADC/A = 3.145728e+09
 the current is the two-exponential FIT, refitted directly in amperes (model $A[\exp(-t/\tau_f) - \exp(-t/\tau_r)]$), 5 free params, pretrigger free in 16383+-3000; the raw trace is drawn only for reference
 integration runs over the whole trace, 0 to 52.43 ms; for the fitted pulse this equals the closed-form integral, so the energy no longer depends on the window



Backup — event 30646, all channels

Z7 event 30646, all channels: fitted current and power
sum over channels from the fits: 3419 eV = 33.0% of 10.37 keV (official-window raw sum 3397 eV = 32.8%)
Z7 24260617_063934, K-line events | method1: $P(t) = I_0(R_L - R_0) * dl(t) + 2 * R_L * L * (dl(t))^2$ | bias point per channel from detectorConfig, ADC/A = 3.145728e+09
the current is the two-exponential FIT, refitted directly in amperes (model $A[\exp(-t/\tau_f) - \exp(-t/\tau_r)]$, 5 free params, pretrigger free in 16383+-3000); the raw trace is drawn only for reference
integration runs over the whole trace, 0 to 52.43 ms; for the fitted pulse this equals the closed-form integral, so the energy no longer depends on the window



Backup — energy distribution of every channel

Z7: energy of every K-line event, one panel per channel (30 series)

each entry is one event: its trace fitted with the two-exponential and the power integrated in closed form, method1 quadratic

the dashed curve is a Gaussian fit to the core, so its centre is the PEAK; these distributions are right skewed, so peaks must not be added (the plain means do add, to 3710 eV = 35.8% of the 10.37 keV K line)

